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### GARMENT WITH CONFIGURABLE SHOULDER SECTIONS

#### Abstract

A garment with configurable shoulder sections is disclosed. The shoulder sections may generally be configured in at least an open configuration and a closed configuration. This may allow the garment to be placed on a person's body without having to manipulate the person's arms through the sleeves.

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## **Background/Summary**

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/796,985, filed Aug. 7, 2024, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/382,265, filed Oct. 20, 2023, now abandoned, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/091,268, filed Dec. 29, 2022, now abandoned, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/586,050, filed Jan. 27, 2022, now abandoned, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/030,362, filed Sep. 23, 2020, now abandoned, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/392,512, filed Apr. 23, 2019, now abandoned, all of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties.

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### **FIELD OF THE INVENTION**

[0003] This invention relates generally to garments, and, more particularly to garments with configurable shoulder sections. The shoulder sections may generally be configured in at least an open configuration and a closed configuration.

### **BACKGROUND**

[0004] Garments such as pull-over shirts may sometimes be difficult to place onto a human body. The garments may first need to be pulled over one's head, and then the person may need to manipulate his/her arms into and through the sleeves. If the sleeves are somewhat tight or otherwise positioned close to the body of the garment, this may be uncomfortable and sometimes even harmful.

[0005] In one particular example, garments designed specifically for infants, while very important to keep the baby warm and safe, are often times difficult to place onto the baby's body without having to bend or otherwise manipulate the baby's head, shoulders and arms to fit within the collar and the sleeves of the garment. Knowing that a baby's body may be extremely fragile and delicate, this may cause discomfort to the baby and sometimes even damage to their body.

[0006] For example, placing a shirt or a onesie onto a baby may require the shirt or onesie to first be pulled over the baby's head. The neck of a baby may be very delicate and fragile such that this action must be done with great care to avoid hurting the baby. Then, when the garment is generally around the baby's neck, the baby's arms must be bent, twisted and manipulated to pull them through the sleeves of the garment. This action may be very unpleasant for the baby and may even cause damage to the baby's arms, joints and internal ligaments. It can also be seen that this same potentially harmful scenario may also be true for any type of person, not just an infant.

[0007] Accordingly, there is a need for a garment that may be placed onto a person's body in such a way that avoids the need to bend, twist or otherwise manipulate the person's body.

[0008] It is desirable, and an object of this invention, to provide a garment that may be placed onto a person in a safe and comfortable way that eliminates the need to manipulate the person's body during the process.

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## **Description**

### **BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS**

[0009] Various other objects, features and attendant advantages of the present invention will

become fully appreciated as the same becomes better understood when considered in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, in which like reference characters designate the same or similar parts throughout the several views, and wherein:

[0010] FIGS. **1-3** show a garment with upper and lower flaps; and

[0011] FIGS. **4** and **5** show a baby placed into a garment with upper and lower flaps.

#### DETAILED DESCRIPTIONS OF EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

[0012] As used herein, unless used otherwise, the following term has the following meaning:

[0013] A “mechanism” refers to any device(s), process(es), routine(s), service(s), or combination thereof. A mechanism may be implemented in hardware, software, firmware, using a special-purpose device, or any combination thereof. A mechanism may be integrated into a single device or it may be distributed over multiple devices. The various components of a mechanism may be co-located or distributed. The mechanism may be formed from other mechanisms. In general, as used herein, the term “mechanism” may thus be considered to be shorthand for the term device(s) and/or process(es) and/or service(s).

[0014] The following detailed description is not intended to limit the current invention. Alternate embodiments and variations of the subject matter described herein will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0015] Garment **10** according to exemplary embodiments hereof is described with reference to FIGS. **1-5**.

[0016] As depicted in FIG. **1**, garment **10** may include an upper portion **100**, a lower portion **102**, a body **104**, an upper opening **106**, a lower opening **108**, a top left shoulder portion **110**, a top right shoulder portion **112**, a front side **114** and a back side **116**. Garment **10** may also include an inside area **117** that may be formed as the region between the front side **114** and the back side **116**. In addition, garment **10** may also include a collar **118** that may be formed as an upper portion of top opening **106**. The upper left shoulder portion **110** and the upper right shoulder portion **112** may also each include at least one upper flap **120** and at least one lower flap **122**. That is, the upper left shoulder portion **110** may include at least one upper flap **120** and at least one lower flap **122**, and the upper right shoulder portion may also include at least one upper flap **120** and at least one lower flap **122**. It should be noted that in this specification, a single upper flap **120** and a single lower flap **122** on each of the left and right sides of the garment **10** may be used as a main example. However, it should be noted that any number of upper and lower flaps **120**, **122** may be used on either the left or right shoulder portions **110**, **112** of the garment **10**.

[0017] Note that the left and right upper tabs **120** may generally be mirror images of each other, and that the left and right lower tabs **122** may generally be mirror images of each other. However, it should be noted that the left and right upper tabs **120** may not generally be mirror images of each other, and that the left and right lower tabs **122** may not generally be mirror images of each other, and that the tabs **120**, **122** may be formed of any type of different shapes and sizes.

[0018] Note that in the configuration depicted in FIG. **1**, top flap **120** may generally be an upper extension of the back **116** of the garment **10**. The flap **120** may be formed of the same material as the back **116** section of the garment **10** such that the top flap **120** may simply extend up from the back **116** on the left and right upper sides. Alternatively, the top flaps **120** may be sewn or otherwise attached to the top of the back section **116** on the upper left and right portions of the garment **10**. In this way, it can be seen that the top flaps **120** and the back portion of the collar **118** may generally form the top of the back **116** of the garment **10**. Other configurations of top flaps **120** with respect to the back **116** of the garment may also be used.

[0019] In addition, the lower flap **122** may generally be an upper extension of the front **114** of the garment **10**. The flap **122** may be formed of the same material as the front **114** section of the garment **10** such that the lower flap **122** may simply extend up from the front **114** on the left and right upper sides. Alternatively, the lower flaps **122** may be sewn or otherwise attached to the top of the front section **114** on the upper left and right portions of the garment **10**. In this way, it can be

seen that the lower flaps **122** and the front portion of the collar **118** may generally form the top of the front **116** of the garment **10**. Other configurations of the lower flaps **122** with respect to the front **114** of the garment may also be used.

[0020] The top opening **106** of the garment **10** may be generally formed as the in-between space between the top flaps **120** and the back portion of the collar **118**, and the lower flaps **122** and the front portion of the collar **118**. That is, the left and right top flaps **120** combined with the back portion of the collar **118** may generally define and form the back side of the opening **116**, and the left and right lower flaps **122** combined with the front portion of the collar **118** may generally define and form the front side of the opening **116**.

[0021] It should be pointed out that the upper shoulder portions of the garment **10** may also be referred to as the yoke of the garment **10** and that in this scenario, the yoke may include the top flaps **120** and the lower flaps **122**, individually or in combination (as will be described below).

[0022] In the example depicted in FIG. **1**, top flap **120** may generally have two main positions, an upper position T and a lower position L. Note that in FIG. **1**, the right upper flap **120** is generally in an upper position T and the left upper flap **120** is generally in a lower position L. In this way, the top left shoulder portion **110** and the top right shoulder portion **112** may be generally configured in at least an open configuration (e.g. when upper flaps **120** are in the upper position T) and in a closed configuration (e.g. when upper flaps **120** are in the lower position L).

[0023] With top flap **120** generally in an upper position T, top flap **120** may fold forward in the direction of arrow A to transition from an upper position T to a lower position L. In addition, when generally in a lower position L, top flap **120** may fold upward in the direction of arrow B to transition from a lower position L to an upper position T.

[0024] It should be noted that when upper flap **120** may be placed in a generally lower position L, a portion of the upper flap **120** may come into physical contact with a portion of the lower flap **122**. This is depicted in FIG. **1** where the left upper flap **122** is in the lower position L and is generally laying over a portion of lower flap **122**. In this configuration, a portion of the inner surface **124** of upper flap **120** may generally overlay a portion of the outer surface **126** of lower flap **122**.

[0025] With top flap **120** and lower flap **122** in physical contact as described above, the top flap **120** and the bottom flap **122** may generally be attached or joined to one another in the area of their physical contact using one or more attachment mechanisms **127**. In this way, the combined upper flap **120** and lower flap **122** may generally form the upper shoulder portions **110**, **112**. The left upper flap **120** combined and joined with the left lower flap **122** may generally form upper left shoulder portion **110**, and the right upper flap **120** combined and joined with the right lower flap **122** may generally form upper right shoulder portion **112**.

[0026] The top flap **120** and the lower flap **122** combinations (left and right) may include attachment mechanisms **127** such as hook and loop material, snaps, buttons, ties, zippers, magnets or other types or combinations of types of attachment mechanisms **127** that may be used to attach and join the top flap **120** with the lower flap **122** for each combination. In this way, the top flap **120** may be attached and joined to the lower flap **122** when it is folded downward into its lower position L.

[0027] In one example as depicted in FIG. **1**, the right top flap **120** and right lower flap **122** may each include one or more attachment mechanisms **127** that may include at least one hook and loop section. For example, top flap **122** may include a hook and loop section **128** and lower flap **122** may include hook and loop section **130**. It may be preferable that if hook and loop section **128** is hook material, that hook and loop section **130** be loop material so that the two sections **128**, **130** may mate and generally attach to one another. Also, it may be preferable that if hook and loop section **128** is loop material, that hook and loop section **130** be hook material so that the two sections **128**, **130** may mate and generally attach and be joined to one another. It may also be preferable that with top tab **120** in the lower position L overlaying lower tab **122**, that at least a portion of hook and loop material section **128** may overlay at least a portion of hook and loop

material section **130** so that the at least overlapping portions of sections **128** and **130** may attach and adhere to one another.

[0028] Note that in one preferable configuration, upper flap **120** may fold forward along an axis that may be generally represented by line C in FIG. **1**. In addition, it may be preferable that the top edge of lower flap **122** generally follow line C as well so that the upper flap **120** may generally fold forward and down across the top edge of flap **122**. Note that the top edge of lower flap **122** may be generally linear so that as upper flap **120** may fold across it, the fold in top flap **120** may also be generally linear such that upper flap **120** may fold uniformly downward over lower flap **122**.

[0029] As shown in FIG. **1**, hook and loop section **128** and hook and loop section **130** may generally be positioned in locations that may be mirrored with each other about line C. In this way, when upper flap **120** may fold forward along line C, its hook and loop section **128** may rotate downward into a position that may generally coincide with the position of hook and loop section **130** that may be configured with lower flap **122**. This is depicted as dashed lines in upper left shoulder section of **110** of garment **10** in FIG. **1**. In this configuration, it may be preferable that the majority of top section **128** may overlap with the majority of lower section **130**, and that the respective sections **128**, **130** may then be pressed together in order for the hook and material of each section to mate and adhere to one another. In this way, top flap **120** may be securely attached to lower flap **122** when in its lower position L. Note that the upper flap **120** and the lower flap **122** may each also include more than one hook and loop section **128**, **130**, and that the sections **128**, **130** may be configured in different positions, locations and configurations.

[0030] It should be noted and appreciated that other types and numbers of attachment mechanisms **127** may also be used to attach upper flap **120** to lower flap **122** in a similar manner as described above. For example, upper flap **120** and lower flap **122** may be attached to one another using one or more snaps, with at least one side of the snap (e.g. the male side and/or female side) configured with the inner surface of upper flap **120**, and at least one of the other side of the snap (e.g. the female and/or male side) configured with the outer surface of the lower flap **122**. As with the example above regarding using hook and loop material sections **128**, **130** as the attachment mechanism, each side of the snap on the upper flap **120** and lower flap **122** respectively may be configured to generally come into physical contact and mate with one another when the upper flap **120** may be folded forward into lower position L and the snap sections are pressed together.

[0031] In another exemplary embodiment hereof, one or more magnets **129** may be used to attach upper flap **120** to lower flap **122** in a similar manner as described above. For example, upper flap **120** and lower flap **122** may be attached to one another using one or more magnets **129**, with at least one magnet **129** configured with the inner surface of upper flap **120** (e.g., sewn into a fold of the material), and at least one magnet **129** configured with the outer surface of the lower flap **122** (e.g., sewn into a fold of the material). As with the example above regarding using hook and loop material sections **128**, **130** as the attachment mechanisms **127**, each magnet **129** on the upper flap **120** and lower flap **122** respectively may be configured to generally come into physical contact and mate with one another when the upper flap **120** may be folded forward into lower position L and the snap sections are pressed together. Note that it may be preferable that the magnetic poles of each magnet **129** be arranged such that the magnets **129** may attract one another when in physical contact with one another as described. In this way, the magnets **129** may adhere to or otherwise hold one another thus attaching the upper flap **120** and the lower flap **122** together as desired.

[0032] Note that the descriptions above and the examples provided are meant for demonstration purposes to benefit this description, and do not limit the current invention in any way. In addition, those of ordinary skill in the art will realize and appreciate, upon reading this description, that other configurations of upper flap **120** and lower flap **122** may also be used and configured with other numbers and types of attachment members **127**. For example, other attachment mechanisms **127** may include one or more latches, hooks, zippers, buttons, and other types or combinations of types of attachment mechanisms **127**. In addition, the attachment mechanisms **127** may be configured in

different positions and/or in other combinations of positions as compared to the positions described in the examples above or below. It is understood that the scope of the garment **10** is not limited in any way by the type, types or combinations of types of attachment mechanisms **127** that may be used.

[0033] It should also be noted that upper flap **120** may be folded downward along other fold lines that may be different than fold line C in FIG. **1**. For example, upper flap **120** may be folded downward along a fold line that may be generally parallel to the x-axis as depicted in FIG. **1**. In general, it should be appreciated that upper flap **120** may be folded downward along any position or fold line that may be in any direction with respect to the x-axis and y-axis of the figure.

[0034] As an alternative to the example depicted in FIG. **1**, it can be seen that the left and right upper flaps **120** may be formed as upper extensions of the front **114** of the garment **10** instead of the back **116**, and that the left and right lower flaps **122** may be formed as upper extensions of the back **116** of the garment instead of the front **114**. In this example, the top flaps **120**, being formed in the front **114** of the garment **10** may fold backwards and downwards instead of forward and downwards as described in the example above. The lower flaps **122** may reside on the back **116** of the garments and may receive the top flaps **120** as they are folded backwards and downwards. In addition, all or at least some of the characteristics of upper and lower flaps **120**, **122** described with respect to the other examples in this specification also apply to this example.

[0035] In yet another example, lower flaps **122** may extend upward such that the flaps **122** may be joined and attached to top flaps **120** towards the top of left and right upper shoulder portions **110**, **112** without the need for top flaps **120** to be folded downward. In this example, top flaps **120** and lower flaps **122** may generally extend to the same height and attach to one another at the top.

[0036] Note that none of the examples described above or in any other sections of this specification limit the scope of the invention in any manner and that other configurations, and combinations of configurations, of upper flap **120** and lower flap **122** with respect to the front **114** and back **116** are also within the scope of the current invention. In general,

[0037] As shown in FIG. **1**, with the left top flap **120** configured with the left lower flap **122** as described, left side opening **132** may be formed. Left side opening **132** may be generally formed by the top flap **120** and the lower flap **122** combination and may extend from outside the garment on the left side of the upper left shoulder portion **110** to the inside **117** of the garment **10**. In this way, left side opening **132** may form the opening of the left sleeve **134**. It may be preferable that left side opening **132** be large enough to easily and comfortably accommodate the arm of the infant that may be placed into the garment **10**.

[0038] Moving now to FIG. **2**, the garment **10** with both the left and right upper flaps **120** configured with their respective lower flaps **122** is depicted. As shown, the left combination of left upper flap **120** and the left lower flap **122** may form the left opening **132** and the left sleeve **134**, and the right combination of the right upper flap **120** and the right lower flap **122** may form the right opening **136** and right sleeve **138**. Note that while left and right sleeves **134**, **138** may appear to be short such that they may not extend out far past the left and right sides of the garment **10**, sleeves **134**, **138** may be longer and may extend well past the left and right sides of the garment respectively. In this way, the sleeves **134**, **138** may be formed into what may referred to as “short sleeves” **134**, **138** (i.e. sleeves that may extend a few inches past the left and right sides of the garment **10**), “three quarter sleeves” **134**, **138** (i.e. sleeves that may extend to just past the elbow region of a person's arm who may be wearing the garment **100**, “long sleeves” **134**, **138** (i.e. sleeves that may generally extend to the wrist region of the person's arm who may be wearing the garment), as well as other types of sleeves **134**, **138**.

[0039] It should be noted that sleeves **134**, **138** may be of any length, shape, size or style, and may utilize the left and right upper flap **120**/lower flap **122** combinations accordingly. It may be preferable that versions of longer sleeved garment **10** primarily include the upper and lower flaps **120**, **122** in the top left shoulder portion **110** and the top right shoulder portion **112** of the garment

**10**. That is, the upper and lower flaps **120**, **122** may not necessarily extend the full length of the longer sleeves **134**, **138** but may instead be generally located in the shoulder regions **110**, **112** where the arms of the person wearing the garment **10** may be most difficult to manipulate into the sleeves **134**, **138**. In this case, the portion of the sleeves **134**, **138** in the areas that may extend out beyond the upper shoulder regions **110**, **112** may generally include what may be viewed as typical sleeves (with an opening into the top of sleeve **134**, **138** just beyond the upper and lower flaps **120**, **122** and a lower opening that may coincide with the wrist region of the person's arm who may be wearing the garment **10**). In this way, the upper and lower flaps **120**, **122** may perform as described in this specification in the areas that may be most difficult to manipulate the user's arm/shoulders into the garment **10**, and in the areas beyond this area, the person's arm may be more easily inserted into the outer areas of the sleeve through the top opening and out the lower opening. Note however that upper and lower tabs **120**, **122** may indeed extend a portion or the entire length of the sleeves **134**, **138** (of any length) as necessary.

#### In Operation

[0040] Turning to FIGS. 3-5, the use and general operation of the garment **10** will now be described by detailed descriptions and by means of example. In this particular example, the garment **10** may include a onesie garment generally used for babies or infants. However, it will be appreciated that this example is only meant for demonstration purposes and does not limit the scope of the garment **10** in any way. It will also be appreciated that the garment **10** may include other types of garments such as shirts, jumpers, one-piece suits, shirts attached to leggings, and other types of garments. It is also noted that the garment **10** may be used with any type of person including infants, toddlers, children, teenagers, young adults, adults, middle aged persons, senior citizens as well as any other type of person.

[0041] As shown in FIG. 3, garment **10** may have a front **114**, a back **116**, an upper opening **106**, a lower opening **108**, an inside **117**, upper flaps **120** and lower flaps **122**. Note that the lower flaps **122** may be folded downwards in this drawing but this may not be required. It should be appreciated that the upper opening **106** and the lower opening **108** may pass into the inside **117** such that the inner cavity **117** of the garment **10** may pass continuously from the upper opening **106** to the lower opening **108**. In this way, the garment **10** may be placed on the body of a person (e.g. an infant **200** or any other type of person) and the portion of the infant's body that is meant to be covered by the garment **10** (e.g. the torso of the infant **200**) may generally be configured within the inside **117** of the garment **10**. This is depicted in FIG. 4. Note that the infant's left and right arms may be positioned generally above the lower flaps **122** and generally below the upper flaps **120**. In this way, the left and right arms may be generally positioned in the area that will form left side opening **132** and right side opening respectively.

[0042] It is important to note that the garment **10** may be placed on the infant **200** (or other person) by placing the feet of the infant **200** through the top opening **106** of the garment **10** and then pulling the garment **10** up and around the baby's torso area as desired (for this particular type of garment). This may allow the avoidance of having to place the garment **10** over the baby's head area which may be preferable in order to avoid handling the baby's fragile neck, shoulders and head. However, given that the top and bottom openings **106**, **108** may be large enough to easily accommodate the baby's head and shoulders, it may be safe to place the lower opening **108** over the baby's head and pull the garment **10** downward over the torso of the baby **200** as desired.

[0043] Once the infant **200** is placed within garment **10** as depicted in FIG. 4, the lower tabs **122** may be folded upward in the direction of arrow D, and the upper tabs **120** may be folded forward and downward in the direction of arrow A. In this way, the upper and lower flaps **120**, **122** may overlay the baby's left and right shoulder and upper arm region as depicted in FIG. 5. The upper flaps **120** and the lower flaps **122** may be secured together utilizing attachment mechanisms **128**, **130** (e.g. hook and loop material sections or other attachment mechanisms) such that the left and right upper flap **120** and lower flap **122** combinations may form the left and right sleeves **134**, **138**

respectively. Note also that the left and right upper flap **120** and lower flap **122** combinations may form the left and right openings **132**, **136** respectively that may form the inner openings of the sleeves **134**, **138**. It may be preferable that the upper and lower flaps **120**, **122** be configured in such a way that left and right openings **132**, **136** and left and right sleeves **134**, **138** be of a size and shape that may easily and comfortably receive and cover the baby's left and right shoulder and upper arm regions.

[0044] It is important to note that at no time during the placement of the garment **10** onto the baby's body was there a need to bend, twist, handle or otherwise manipulate the baby's left and right arms into the left and right sleeves **134**, **138** since the upper and lower flaps **120**, **122** were configured around the baby's left and right arms to form the sleeves **134**, **138** without any movement required of the baby's arms. In this way, the delicate and fragile arms of the baby are safe from uncomfortable and potentially damaging manipulations into the sleeves **134**, **138**.

[0045] To remove the garment **10** from the person's body, the reverse procedure may be followed. The upper and lower flaps **120**, **122** may be disconnected from one another in order to open up the top of the garment **10**. The garment may then be easily removed, again, without having to bend, twist or otherwise manipulate the person's arms, shoulders or neck.

[0046] Note that in this example of a onesie that may be used with a baby or infant, the garment **10** may also include a lower center front flap **140** and a lower center rear flap **146** that may be configured to generally close the lower opening **108** of the garment **10** around the baby's leg and groin areas. The lower center front flap **140** and lower center rear flap **142** may each include attachment mechanisms **144** **146** similar to the attachment mechanisms used in relation to upper and lower flaps **120**, **122** (e.g. hook and loop material) to be secured to one another.

[0047] As shown in FIG. **4** and FIG. **5**, the lower center front flap **140** may be folded downward and the lower center rear flap **142** may be folded forward to be joined together in the area between the baby's left and right legs. In this way, the lower portion of the garment **10** may be generally closed such that the garment is secured to the baby's body. To open the bottom portion of the garment **10** in order to remove it from the baby's body, the lower center front flap **142** may be disconnected from the lower center rear flap **142** and the bottom opening **108** may be opened wide for the removal of the baby.

[0048] It is understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art that any and/or all of the aspects of any of the above described embodiments may be combined in any way, and that the system **10** is not limited in any way by any combination of the aspects of any exemplary embodiments.

[0049] While a particular form of the invention has been illustrated and described, it will be apparent that various modifications can be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention. Accordingly, it is not intended that the invention be limited, except as by the appended claims.

[0050] Those of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate and understand, upon reading this description, that embodiments hereof may provide different and/or additional advantages, and that not all embodiments or implementations need have all advantages.

[0051] A person of ordinary skill in the art will understand, that any method described above or below and/or claimed and described as a sequence of steps is not restrictive in the sense of the order of steps.

[0052] Where a process is described herein, those of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that the process may operate without any user intervention. In another embodiment, the process includes some human intervention (e.g., a step is performed by or with the assistance of a human).

[0053] As used herein, including in the claims, the phrase "at least some" means "one or more," and includes the case of only one. Thus, e.g., the phrase "at least some ABCs" means "one or more ABCs", and includes the case of only one ABC.

[0054] As used herein, including in the claims, term "at least one" should be understood as meaning "one or more", and therefore includes both embodiments that include one or multiple



components. Furthermore, dependent claims that refer to independent claims that describe features with “at least one” have the same meaning, both when the feature is referred to as “the” and “the at least one”.

[0055] As used in this description, the term “portion” means some or all. So, for example, “A portion of X” may include some of “X” or all of “X”. In the context of a conversation, the term “portion” means some or all of the conversation.

[0056] As used herein, including in the claims, the phrase “using” means “using at least,” and is not exclusive. Thus, e.g., the phrase “using X” means “using at least X.” Unless specifically stated by use of the word “only”, the phrase “using X” does not mean “using only X.”

[0057] As used herein, including in the claims, the phrase “based on” means “based in part on” or “based, at least in part, on,” and is not exclusive. Thus, e.g., the phrase “based on factor X” means “based in part on factor X” or “based, at least in part, on factor X.” Unless specifically stated by use of the word “only”, the phrase “based on X” does not mean “based only on X.”

[0058] In general, as used herein, including in the claims, unless the word “only” is specifically used in a phrase, it should not be read into that phrase.

[0059] As used herein, including in the claims, the phrase “distinct” means “at least partially distinct.” Unless specifically stated, distinct does not mean fully distinct. Thus, e.g., the phrase, “X is distinct from Y” means that “X is at least partially distinct from Y,” and does not mean that “X is fully distinct from Y.” Thus, as used herein, including in the claims, the phrase “X is distinct from Y” means that X differs from Y in at least some way.

[0060] It should be appreciated that the words “first,” “second,” and so on, in the description and claims, are used to distinguish or identify, and not to show a serial or numerical limitation.

Similarly, letter labels (e.g., “(A)”, “(B)”, “(C)”, and so on, or “(a)”, “(b)”, and so on) and/or numbers (e.g., “(i)”, “(ii)”, and so on) are used to assist in readability and to help distinguish and/or identify, and are not intended to be otherwise limiting or to impose or imply any serial or numerical limitations or orderings. Similarly, words such as “particular,” “specific,” “certain,” and “given,” in the description and claims, if used, are to distinguish or identify, and are not intended to be otherwise limiting.

[0061] As used herein, including in the claims, the terms “multiple” and “plurality” mean “two or more,” and include the case of “two.” Thus, e.g., the phrase “multiple ABCs,” means “two or more ABCs,” and includes “two ABCs.” Similarly, e.g., the phrase “multiple PQRs,” means “two or more PQRs,” and includes “two PQRs.”

[0062] The present invention also covers the exact terms, features, values and ranges, etc. in case these terms, features, values and ranges etc. are used in conjunction with terms such as about, around, generally, substantially, essentially, at least etc. (i.e., “about 3” or “approximately 3” shall also cover exactly 3 or “substantially constant” shall also cover exactly constant).

[0063] As used herein, including in the claims, singular forms of terms are to be construed as also including the plural form and vice versa, unless the context indicates otherwise. Thus, it should be noted that as used herein, the singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” include plural references unless the context clearly dictates otherwise.

[0064] Throughout the description and claims, the terms “comprise”, “including”, “having”, and “contain” and their variations should be understood as meaning “including but not limited to”, and are not intended to exclude other components unless specifically so stated.

[0065] It will be appreciated that variations to the embodiments of the invention can be made while still falling within the scope of the invention. Alternative features serving the same, equivalent or similar purpose can replace features disclosed in the specification, unless stated otherwise. Thus, unless stated otherwise, each feature disclosed represents one example of a generic series of equivalent or similar features.

[0066] The present invention also covers the exact terms, features, values and ranges, etc. in case these terms, features, values and ranges etc. are used in conjunction with terms such as about,

around, generally, substantially, essentially, at least etc. (i.e., “about 3” shall also cover exactly 3 or “substantially constant” shall also cover exactly constant).

[0067] Use of exemplary language, such as “for instance”, “such as”, “for example” (“e.g.”) and the like, is merely intended to better illustrate the invention and does not indicate a limitation on the scope of the invention unless specifically so claimed.

[0068] While the invention has been described in connection with what is presently considered to be the most practical and preferred embodiments, it is to be understood that the invention is not to be limited to the disclosed embodiment, but on the contrary, is intended to cover various modifications and equivalent arrangements included within the spirit and scope of the appended claims.

[0069] Although certain presently preferred embodiments of the invention have been described herein, it will be apparent to those skilled in the art to which the invention pertains that variations and modifications of the described embodiments may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention.

## Claims

1. A garment comprising: a top opening with a front and a back; at least one first flap configured with the back of the top opening; and at least one second flap configured with the front of the top opening; wherein the at least one first flap and at the least one second flap are joined to form at least one sleeve of the garment.
2. The garment of claim 1, further comprising attachment mechanisms configured with the at least one first flap and the at least one second flap.
3. The garment of claim 2, wherein the attachment mechanisms join the at least one first flap to the at least one second flap.
4. The garment of claim 3, wherein the attachment mechanisms are hook and loop material.
5. The garment of claim 1, wherein the type of garment is chosen from the group of types: a shirt, a onesie, a jumper and a one piece suit.
6. The garment of claim 1, wherein the garment is placed on the body of a person by placing the person's feet through the top opening of the garment.
7. The garment of claim 6, wherein the person is an infant.
8. A garment comprising: a top opening with a front and a back; at least one first flap configured with the back of the top opening and configured with at least one first attachment mechanism; and at least one second flap configured with the front of the top opening and configured with at least one second attachment mechanism; wherein the at least one first attachment mechanism and the at least one second attachment mechanism are joined to join the at least one first flap with the at least one second flap; and wherein the joined at least one first flap and at least one second flap form at least one sleeve of the garment.
9. The garment of claim 8, wherein the attachment mechanisms are hook and loop material.
10. The garment of claim 8, wherein the type of garment is chosen from the group of types: a shirt, a onesie, a jumper and a one piece suit.
11. The garment of claim 8, wherein the garment is placed on the body of a person by placing the person's feet through the top opening of the garment.
12. The garment of claim 11, wherein the person is an infant.
13. A garment comprising: a top opening with a front and a back; at least one first flap configured with the back of the top opening and configured with at least one first section of hook and loop material; and at least one second flap configured with the front of the top opening and configured with at least one second section of hook and loop material; wherein the at least one first section of hook and loop material and the at least one second section of hook and loop material are joined to join the at least one first flap with the at least one second flap; and wherein the joined at least one

first flap and at least one second flap form at least one sleeve of the garment.

**14.** The garment of claim 13, wherein the type of garment is chosen from the group of types: a shirt, a onesie, a jumper and a one piece suit.

**15.** The garment of claim 13, wherein the garment is placed on the body of a person by placing the person's feet through the top opening of the garment.

**16.** The garment of claim 15, wherein the person is an infant.

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